

SMS Funda Pack

Hold on for a moment before sending that SMS! First ensure that the cell number of your friend is in the international cellular number (more accurately, SMSC number) format. This format includes a two-digit number that you have to add before the mobile phone number to which the SMS has to be sent. For Indian SMSCs, you have to type +91 followed by the mobile number. Some of the SMSC numbers of Indian mobile services will look like the following after conversion:

- BPL Mobile:**
+919821000005
- MAXtouch India:**
+919820005446
- Essar Cellphone:**
+919811009998
- Tata:** +919848001104
- Command:**
+919830099990

If you plan to use free SMS Web services, certain requirements need to be met. First of all, you should have a PC with Internet access. It also helps if you have a mobile phone as many of the sites require you to have a mobile phone for registration.

to send an SMS to an Orange mobile number, say, 982017XXXX, all you have to do is send an e-mail to 982017XXXX@maxtouch.co.in. The biggest problem here, of course, is that you would need to know the mobile service provider of the recipient as well as his e-mail address in order to successfully send your message.

SMS via Web sites

Another alternative is to use Web sites that provide free SMS messaging facilities. Some of the free SMS Web services that offer these facilities are www.mtnsms.com, www.hooya.com, www.voicestream.com, and www.blueskyfrog.com. MTNSMS is absolutely free, with no strings attached (see box, 'MTNSMS—Swift and Simple'). VoiceStream and BlueSkyFrog have limitations in the form of points for using their service. For additional SMS services such as ring tones, you have to pay for additional points.

Sending SMS using IMs

In case you haven't noticed, many IMs such as MSN Messenger and ICQ offer SMS messaging services. MSN Messenger offers SMS services as standard, but the person to whom you want to send an SMS has to have an MSN passport and enable the option for you (or anyone else) to send messages to his mobile. All that you then have to do is to right-click on the name and select Send a message to a Mobile device.

To enable other people to send SMS via MSN Messenger to your mobile, go to Tools, select 'Send a Message to a Mobile Device', and then click on 'Edit my Paging Settings' or 'Setup my Pager Address', depending on the version of MSN you are using. Register your mobile device, after which you will be sent the authorisation code. Enter the code and then proceed to personalise your settings using the Phone preferences. Fill in the numbers and click on 'Go to

Operation of SMS Web Services

Short Message Service (SMS) is defined as the transmission of short text messages to and from a mobile phone, fax machine, or an IP address. These plain text messages have a maximum limit of 160 alphanumeric characters, and cannot have images or graphics.

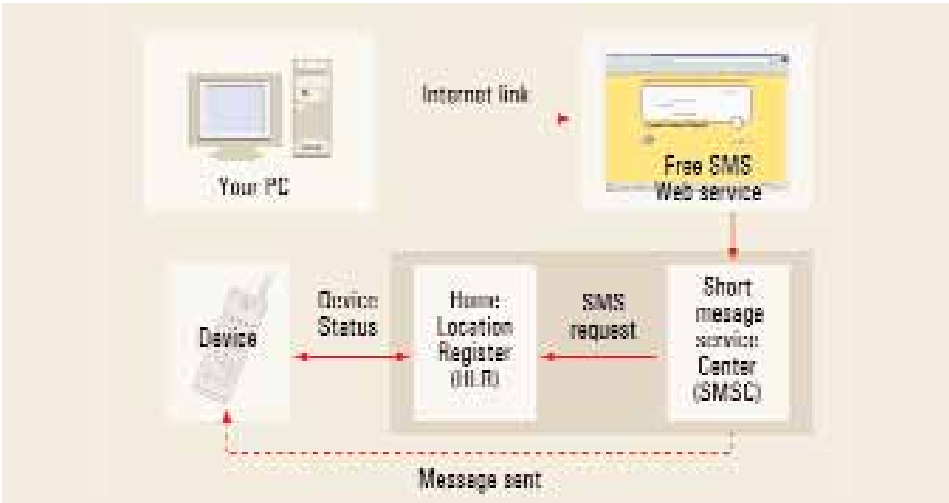
Let's consider that a message has been sent from a Web site or application that offers SMS services. The message is routed by the service to the user's cellular network. It is received by a Short Message Service Centre (SMSC), which directs the message to the recipient's cell phone.

The SMSC sends an SMS request to the Home Location Register (HLR) to find the roaming customer. Once the request is received by HLR, it responds to the SMSC with the subscriber's status (active or inactive) and roaming

location. If the status is inactive, SMSC stores the message for a specified period of time. When the device is active, the HLR sends an SMS notification to the SMSC, which then tries to deliver the message.

SMSC uses a Short Message Delivery Point to Point format for transmission of the message to the serving system. The system contacts the mobile and if it responds, SMSC tries to deliver the message. When the message is received by the user, it is categorised as 'sent' and is not sent again.

And if you have a mobile, the moment you receive an SMS message, you get two short beeps (or any other sound that you may have pre-configured), to indicate that you have received an SMS message. So, go ahead and read that message.



Infographic: Jaya Shetty

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